

MICHAELA VIVIENNE SANTIAGO

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Portfolio: <https://miavies.github.io/github-portfolio/>

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Creative game developer with practical experience in Unity, C# scripting, gameplay programming, UI implementation, asset integration, animation, and QA debugging. Recipient of multiple CIIT Best Work recognitions, runner-up at the CIIT Game Jam 2026, and participant in the Philippine Game Development Expo (PGDX) 2025. Consistent Dean's List student with an analytical engineering background and strong foundations in game mathematics, physics, and scalable gameplay systems.

CORE SKILLS & COMPETENCIES

Technical Skills

- **Programming Languages:** C#, Java, HTML, CSS, JavaScript, C++, BASIC
- **Developer Tools & Version Control:** GitHub, MS Visual Studio, Visual Studio Code, Arduino, MS Visual Basic
- **Game Engines & 3D Design Software:** Unity, AutoCAD, Blender
- **2D Design Software:** Adobe Photoshop, Adobe Illustrator, Clip Studio Paint, Aseprite, Canva
- **Audio Design Software:** Adobe Audition
- **Video Editing Software:** Adobe Premier Pro
- **Website Builder:** Duda
- **Office Document Tools:** MS Office, Google Workspace, Zoho Workplace

Soft Skills

- Excellent written and verbal communication skills in English and Filipino
- Interpersonal skills with a people-first approach while achieving objectives
- Effective independent and collaborative team player
- Strong organizational, time management, and multitasking skills
- Leadership and project coordination skills
- Proactive and empathetic mindset
- Adaptability to diverse workflows, processes, and client requirements
- Open-minded perspective on game design and player preferences
- Strong problem-solving and critical-thinking abilities
- High attention to detail
- Strong digital drawing fundamentals
- Creativity and innovation
- Mechanical design and evaluation capabilities

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Consistent Dean's List student (Current GPA: 3.89) and recipient of the Gold Weave Award for ranking among the top 1 to 10 students on the Dean's List
- First runner-up at CIIT Global Game Jam 2026
- Chosen for Best Work for the following academic projects:
 - Games: Tusok at Tiyaga, Deep Space Tavern, Death's Brew, Monster Market Madness
 - Others: Portfolio website, Digital drawing
- Participant in PGDX 2025 with Deep Space Tavern
- Designed and built the Examiners Edge website and implemented SEO strategies, establishing its online presence, and contributing to increased client acquisition

PROJECTS

- **Poblacion: Tour Through the Past**
The project increased players' historical awareness by 26.45% and convinced 93.18% of players to visit Poblacion, the Historical District of Makati City.
Developed dialogue, cutscene, and scene loading systems; implemented dialogue sequences and created cutscenes using Animation and Timeline features; created environmental art assets and NPC animations; designed and implemented the stacking minigame, including its gameplay mechanics, scripting, art, and animations; and integrated scripts and assets to ensure seamless functionality.
- **Tusok at Tiyyaga**
Developed core gameplay systems, including cooking mechanics, shopping and currency systems, ingredient requirements, power-up mechanics, dialogue, level difficulty progression, scene loading, and UI interactions; created UI and asset animations; and integrated scripts and assets to ensure seamless gameplay.
- **Deep Space Tavern**
Developed NPC AI, UX features, and shop upgrade systems; implemented gameplay mechanics for ingredient spawning, food preparation, pickup, and customer serving; balanced item prices and cooking times; created and customized character animations; and integrated scripts and assets to ensure cohesive and polished gameplay.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- **Unity UI/UX Designer and Programmer – PDEA, Quezon City (May – June 2026)**
Developed UI/UX, integrated UI assets with scripts, and configured Unity UI elements, including panels, buttons, toggles, scroll views, input fields, images, menus, and pop-ups. Developed, tested, debugged, and performed quality assurance to ensure stable, polished, and functional gameplay systems.
- **Project Engineer – Examiners Edge, Duncanville, Texas (May 2024 – April 2026)**
- **Freelance Video Editor – Quezon City (March 2023 – April 2026)**
- **Freelance Digital Artist/ Graphic Artist – Quezon City (January 2019 – August 2023)**
Focused on creating digital paintings, logos, packaging designs, character designs, backgrounds
- **University Research Associate II – Center for Agri-Fisheries and Biosystems Mechanization (BIOMECH), Los Baños (March – August 2023)**
- **Junior Project Assistant – Agricultural Machinery Testing and Evaluation Center (AMTEC), Los Baños (January – June 2022)**
- **Junior Engineering Assistant – Agricultural Machinery Testing and Evaluation Center (AMTEC), Los Baños (March 2020 - December 2021)**
- **Research Assistant – Agricultural Machinery Testing and Evaluation Center (AMTEC), Los Baños (March - August 2019)**

EDUCATION

- **BS in Entertainment and Multimedia Computing – CIIT College of Innovation and Integrated Technology, Quezon City (Expected Graduation Date: October 2027)**
 - Relevant Course Work: Artificial Intelligence for Game Dev, Web Programming, Software Quality Engineering, Free Hand and Digital Drawing, Computer Graphics Programming, Usability, HCI, UI Design, Audio Design and Sound Engineering, Scriptwriting and Storyboard Design, Game Design and Production Process, Applied Mathematics and Physics for Games, Game Programming, Game Networking, 2D Animation, 3D Animation
- **BS in Agricultural and Biosystems Engineering – University of the Philippines, Los Baños (July 2013 – July 2019)**
 - Relevant Course Work: Introduction to Computer Programming

CERTIFICATIONS & TRAININGS

- AI Engineering Workshop for Game Development – CIIT (June 27, 2026)
- Crafting of a Compelling Story: Techniques for Animation and Film – CIIT (November 7, 2024)
- Creative Chronicles: Writing for Games (November 13, 2023)
- Principles of Graphic Design – University of the Philippines Open University, Los Baños (February - March 2023)
- Agricultural and Biosystems Engineering Board Passer (October 2019)